

# Dr. Elena Leuschner

## Academic Positions

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since 02/2025      **PostDoc**, University of Münster, at the Chair of Comparative Politics of Daniel Bischof

## Education

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09/2020 - 01/2025      **PhD**, University of Gothenburg, Department of Political Science  
Thesis: “The Causes and Consequences of Government Concessions to Protest”, supervisors Carl Dahlström and Johannes Lindvall

10/2018 - 06/2020      **MA**, International Administration and Conflict Management with methods specialization, University of Konstanz (1,1)  
Thesis: “Breaking the Wave? The Impact of Government Concessions on Protest Mobilisation” (1,0), supervisor Sebastian Hellmeier

09/2019 - 06/2020      **MSc**, International Administration and Global Governance, University of Gothenburg (with Distinction)

10/2014 - 09/2018      **BA**, Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz

## Fellowships and visits

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01/2024 - 04/2024      **Visiting researcher**, Oxford University, Department of Political Science and International Relations

05/2022      **Visiting researcher**, WZB Berlin Social Science Center  
Professor Daniel Ziblatt, Transformation of Democracy Unit

03/2022 - 09/2024      **Research assistant**, University of Gothenburg,  
Professor Carl Dahlström and Dr. Mikael Holmgren, Text analysis for “Setting the Agenda in the Swedish Riksdag: Partisan Politics and Commissions of Inquiry, 1971-2021”.

09/2019 - 09/2022      **Research fellow**, University of Konstanz,  
Professor Steffen Eckhard, Research group ‘Public Administration and Organization Theory’

# List of publications

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## Peer-reviewed papers

- 2024 Simon Gren and **Elena Leuschner**. 2024. “Outcome Isn’t Everything: Electoral Consequences of Implementing or Withdrawing Unpopular Policies.” *Political Behavior* 46: 2677–2697. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11109-024-09936-8>.
- 2024 **Leuschner, Elena**, and Sebastian Hellmeier. 2024. “State Concessions and Protest Mobilization in Authoritarian Regimes.” *Comparative Political Studies* 57(1): 3–31. <http://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/00104140231169022>.
- 2024 Eckhard, Steffen, Vytautas Jankauskas, and **Elena Leuschner**. 2023. “Institutional Design and Biases in Evaluation Reports by International Organizations.” *Public Administration Review*: 1–14. <https://doi.org/10.1111/puar.13705>.
- 2023 Eckhard, Steffen, Vytautas Jankauskas, **Elena Leuschner**, Ian Burton, Tilman Kerl, Rita Sevastjanova. 2023. “The Performance of International Organizations: A New Measure and Dataset Based on Computational Text Analysis of Evaluation Reports.” *The Review of International Organizations*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11558-023-09489-1>.

## Book chapters

- 2024 Sebastian Hellmeier, **Elena Leuschner**. 2024 “Elections and autocratization.” Aurel Croissant, Luca Tomini (Eds). *The Routledge Handbook of Autocratization*. Routledge. 166-180.

## Other

- 2025 **Elena Leuschner**. 2025 “The Causes and Consequences of Government Concessions to Protests. <https://gupea.ub.gu.se/handle/2077/84117>.

## Papers in progress

Do Business Interest Groups Bias the Policymaking Process? Evidence from 67,950 Public Referrals in Sweden, with Carl Dahlström

Citizens’ Narrow Views of Democracy: Insights from Open-Ended Survey Responses, with Mirko Wegemann, Tim Lars Allinger, Daniel Bischof, Kristian Frederiksen, Morgan Le Corre Juratic

Citizens' Narrow Views of Democracy: Insights from Open-Ended Survey Responses, with Mirko Wegemann, Tim Lars Allinger, Daniel Bischof, Kristian Frederiksen, Morgan Le Corre Juratic

Does the Effect of Political Participation Depend on the Status of the Participator?, with Jesper Lindqvist, Jennifer Oser

Asymmetric Responsiveness: The Effects of Protesters' Demographics and Policy Preferences on the Political Agenda (available as working paper).

Peaceful, Large, and Actionable — Experimental Evidence from Belgium on Local Politicians' Responsive Reactions to Protests (*under review*, available as working paper).

The Emotional Dynamics of Protest, with Luca Versteegen (*under review*, available as working paper).

The Implementation of the World Food Program's Peacebuilding Policy – An Analysis based on Country-level Reports, with Steffen Eckhard and Jan Kemper (available as working paper).

## Policy paper

2023

Steets, Julia; Claudia Meier; Alexander Gaus; Sarah Bressan; Inji El Bakry; Steffen Eckhart; Jan Kemper; **Elena Leuschner** (external evaluation team). Evaluation of the Policy on WFP's Role in Peacebuilding in Transition Settings. Centralized evaluation report. <https://docs.wfp.org/api/documents/WFP-0000146160/download/>.

## Conferences and invited talks

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2025

Presenter: APSA (Vancouver), EPSA (Madrid), GEPOP Internal Conference (Gothenburg), Quality of Government conference (Gothenburg University)

2024

Presenter: APSA (Philadelphia), EPSA (Cologne), ISA (San Francisco), Work in Progress Seminar Series (Oxford University)

2023

Presenter: APSA (Los Angeles, declined), EPSA (Glasgow), Comparative Institutions and Regimes Seminar Series (Oslo University), Comparative Politics Seminar Series (Lund University), General Research Seminar Series (Gothenburg University)

- 2022                      Presenter: APSA (Montreal), ISA (Nashville, online), Public Administration and Public Policy (Gothenburg University), Quality of Government conference (Gothenburg University), Research Group on Elections, Public Opinion and Political Behavior (Gothenburg University)
- 2021                      Presenter: ECPR General Conference (online), International Public Administrations Workshop (LMU Munich), Conflict Dynamics Workshop (Oxford, online), German Association of Peace and Conflict Studies (AFK) (Frankfurt, online)
- 2020                      Presenter: ECPR General Conference, (presenter, online)

## Teaching

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|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025      | Lecturer: Democracy Needs You? Political Participation from a Comparative Perspective (BA), University of Münster                       |
| 2025      | Lecturer: Introduction to R for Political Scientists (BA), University of Münster                                                        |
| 2025      | Lecturer: Voices of Change? The Political Effects of Protests (MA), University of Münster                                               |
| 2025      | Lecturer: Data Science in R for Political Scientists (MA), University of Münster                                                        |
| 2022-2024 | Lecturer: Introduction to Applied Research Design and Quantitative Research Methods for Social Scientist (MA), University of Gothenburg |
| 2022-2024 | Lecturer: The Swedish Welfare State (BA), University of Gothenburg                                                                      |
| 2021-2024 | Teaching assistant on Academic Writing (MA), University of Gothenburg                                                                   |
| 2021-2024 | Supervising Bachelor theses (5 of which 3 with distinction), University of Gothenburg                                                   |

## Awards and grants

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| 2021 | Best paper award, by the Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis for “ <i>Learning or contestation: Analyzing political biases in international organization evaluation reports</i> ” |
| 2023 | Royal Society of Arts and Sciences in Gothenburg: (75,000 SEK)                                                                                                                       |
| 2023 | Helge Ax:son (70,000 SEK)                                                                                                                                                            |
| 2023 | Siamon (11,840 SEK)                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 2023 | W& M Lundgren (75,000 SEK)                                                                                                                                                           |
| 2023 | Donationsnämndens stipendier (15,000 SEK)                                                                                                                                            |
| 2023 | Swedish National Election Studies (26,550 SEK)                                                                                                                                       |
| 2023 | Lars Hiertas Minne Stiftelsen (30,000 SEK)                                                                                                                                           |
| 2022 | Adlerbertska Stiftelsen (20,000 SEK)                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2022 | APSA travel grant (200 USD)                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2021 | Adlerbertska Stiftelsen (30,000 SEK)                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2020 | German Academic Exchange Service DAAD (8,600 EUR)                                                                                                                                    |

## Academic services and memberships

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| Referee     | American Journal of Political Science, British Journal of Political Science, Democratization, International Political Science Review, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Social Movement Studies, Social Problems |
| Memberships | American Political Science Association (APSA), European Political Science Association (EPSA)                                                                                                                   |

## Special knowledge

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| Languages | German: native speaker; English: proficient user; French: independent user |
| Software  | R, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X, Python, Stata                          |

## References

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|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Carl Dahlström    | Professor, University of Gothenburg<br><a href="mailto:carl.dahlstrom@pol.gu.se">carl.dahlstrom(at)pol.gu.se</a>    |
| Johannes Lindvall | Professor, University of Gothenburg<br><a href="mailto:johannes.lindvall@gu.se">johannes.lindvall(at)gu.se</a>      |
| Daniel Bischof    | Professor, University of Münster<br><a href="mailto:dan.bischof@uni-muenster.de">dan.bischof(at)uni-muenster.de</a> |

November 17, 2025